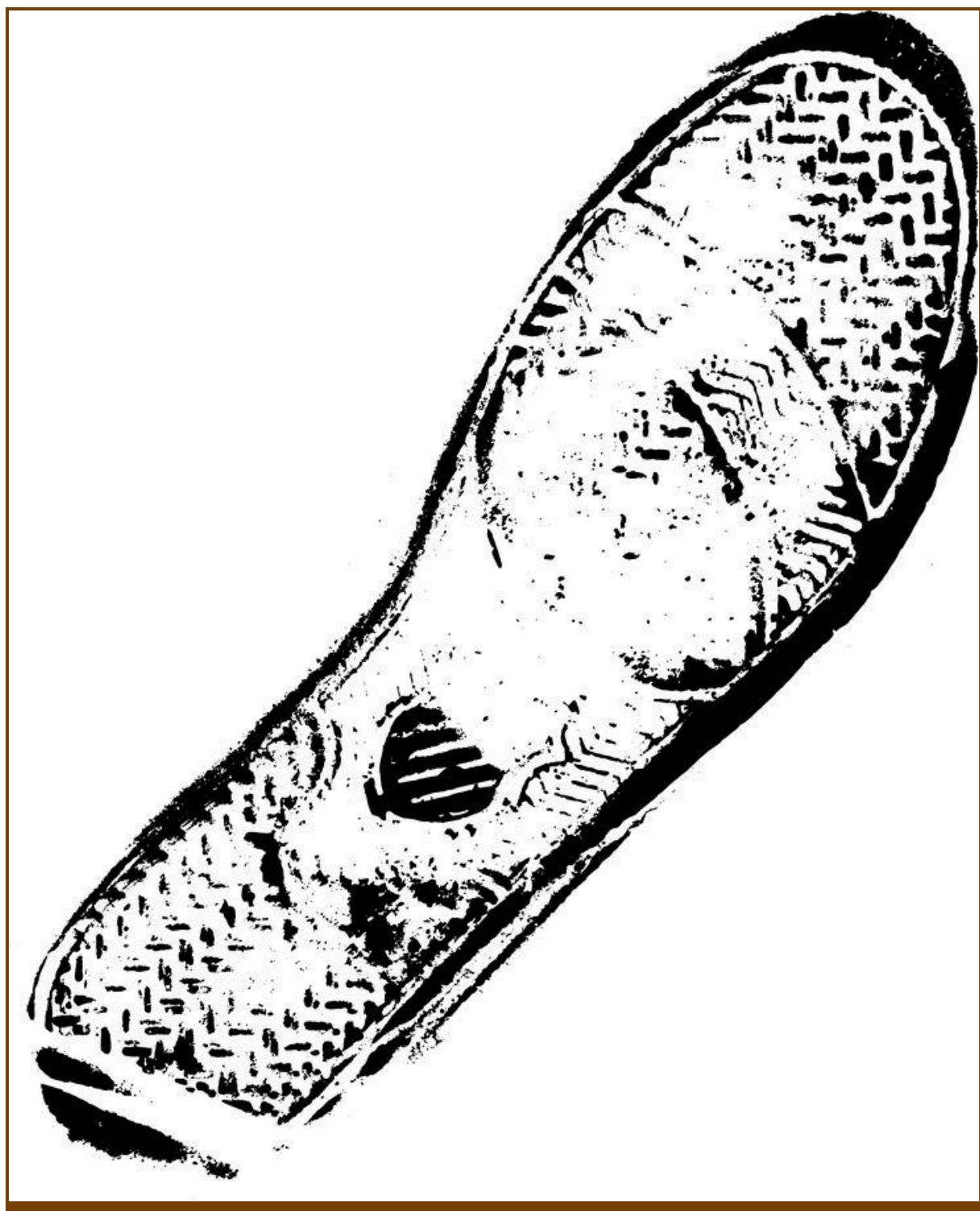


Kalombe Jonathan Mubalo

Problem Statement with the input, function and output of the solution

PROBLEM STATEMENT:

The availability of shoes for people with big feet.



IDENTIFYING THE PROBLEM

What is the problem that we are faced with.

The problem we are faced with is that people with big feet often find it hard to buy shoes that they like in stores. This would often result in a person who would have a big shoe like a woman with a size 7 foot or a man with a size 11 foot having to struggle to find their desired shoe size in shops and therefore spending more time walking from shop to shop in a mall just to find their shoe size. This is because the most manufactured and popular shoe sizes are women size 4 to 6 and men size 8 to 10.

This means that bigger shoe sizes for men and women are available; they are just harder to find in retail stores as studies show that the average time spent on shopping for a new shoe varies from fifty minutes to an hour while the time spent shopping for a rare shoe size would vary from two to three hours.

Some of the reasons why it would be difficult to find size 11 to 12 shoes for men and size 7 to 8 shoes for women in retail stores are listed below.

1. Manufacturing bias- This means that the production of the shoes and the orders from retail stores would often be limited to the average shoe size for men which is size 9 and below while the average shoe size for women would be size 6 and below. This is usually done to ensure that their target market is broad and therefore leading to a pleasing profit margin.

2. Low demand-Research shows that there is a low demand in the market for shoes that are size 9 and above for men and size 6 and above for women because of their population being the minority in terms of foot sizes. Therefore shoe manufacturing companies set aside less resources to ensure that bigger shoe sizes are produced in bulk as the distribution of that stock would not be as high as the distribution of shoe sizes 9 and below for men and 6 and below for women. This is because retail stores would order a low amount of stock in this shoe size range to prevent stock from piling up in their stores when they do not have enough customers.

3. High production cost-Manufacturers also refrain from producing larger shoe sizes due to having to sell a size 10 shoe and a size 8 shoe at roughly the same price. This does not benefit them as it leads to requiring more resources and materials to produce the size 10 than it would the size 8. This requirement is not always catered for in the difference in pricing of the same design hence the manufacturers would produce less big sizes to prevent profit loss.

How does the problem affect customers

The three reasons mentioned above support why oversized shoes are rare in retail stores. Those reasons also define the problem which we are trying to fix; making quality shoes become more available to clients with oversized feet.

This is because someone with an oversized foot would often have to settle for a shoe design or colour that they never wanted to buy because they couldn't find the shoe they like in their shoe size.

They would also have to spend more time walking around from store to store in different malls because of the scarcity of their desired choice in their shoe size.



This would lead people with big feet with the reality of having to settle for shoe designs that they do not like because it is the only shoe that they could find.



Recommended solutions

After reviewing the problem our clients are faced with, I have come up with two solutions to counter the problem which we are tackling.

SOLUTION 1:

Online shoe store with medium to oversized shoe sizes available for purchase and delivery.

To combat the scarcity of oversized shoes in stores; I want to propose the solution of an online store which would have shoes of size 8 to 12 for men and size 6 to 9 for women available for purchase.

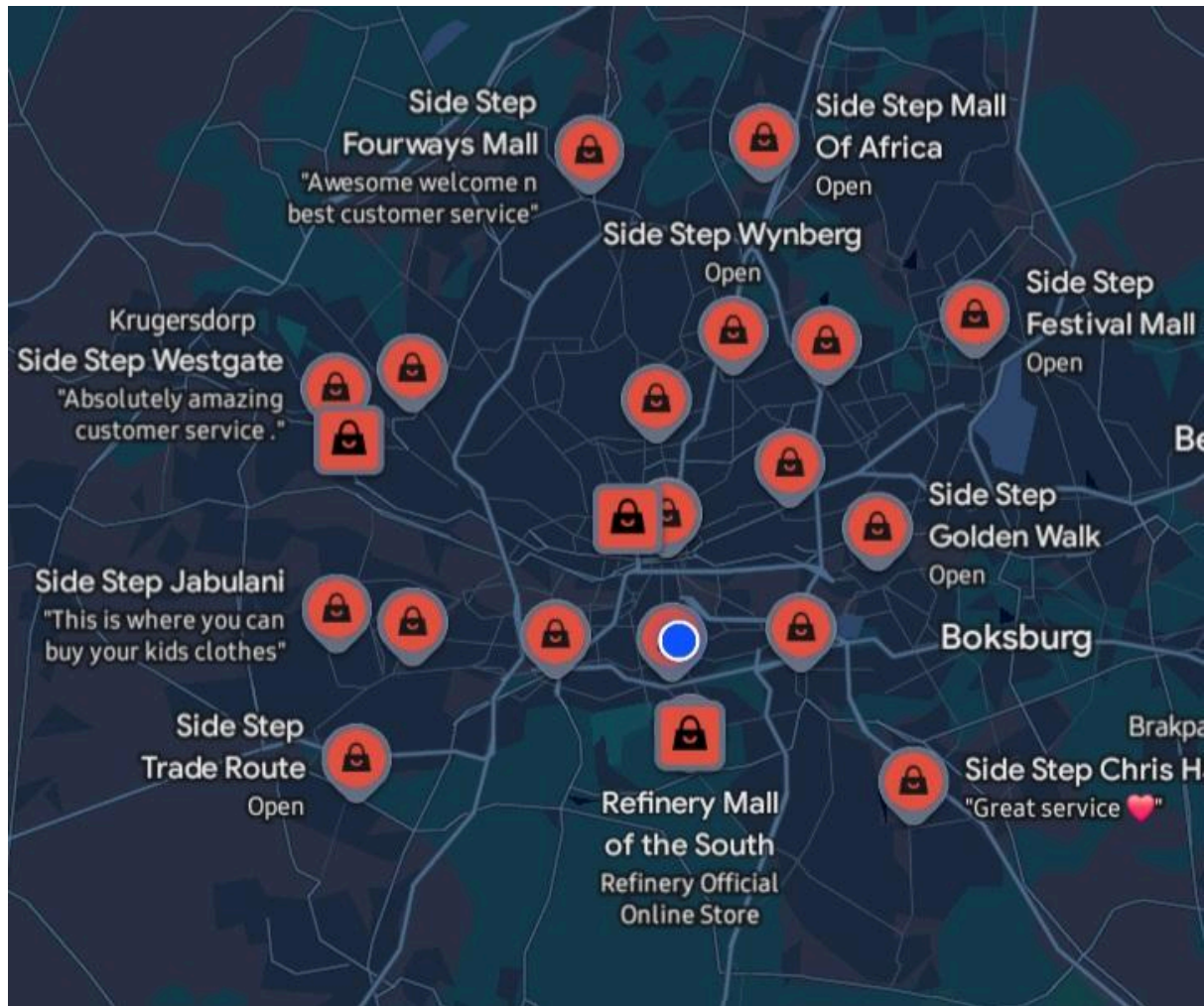
This would allow people with big feet to spend less time at malls by just purchasing what they want directly from my website online.

I would need to get partnering stores and branches that would allow my app to send them email requests asking if they have the shoe that was ordered on my app. After they confirm having the required shoe. My app would then send a response to the client ordering that shoe, notifying them that their order would be delivered to them within four business days.

The store branches that I would want to partner with would be:

- 1.Side step
- 2.Sudio 88
- 3.Sportscene
- 4.Shoe city
- 5.Kingsmead shoes
- 6.Splitz

The main reason why would want to partner with these three stores is because they have multiple branches across Gauteng and South Africa, making it easier for me to handle transportation fees. This would be done by always ensuring that the store that I would get the product from is close enough to the delivery destination therefore cutting on fuel costs.



To run my online store I would need:

1. Cooperation of stores to give us access to their trading stock that we advertise online on my app.
2. Delivery employees with delivery vehicles.
3. Good online advertisement to attract our target market.
4. Easy to use and accessible app on playstore.

Reason why I would need these resources:

1. The Cooperation of stores to allow us to access their trading stock that we advertise online.

•My app would allow a customer to look for the shoe that they want in a short period of time without having to leave their houses. They would purchase their desired shoe on my app. When they have confirmed their order, my website would be required to send emails to all the store branches I would be partnering with requesting the shoe design the customer wants in their size. The moment one store responds confirming that, my app would then

notify the client that their purchase was successful and would be delivered to them within four businessdays. Therefore requiring my business to buy the shoe online from the physical store that confirmed having it available in stock and transport the exact shoe that the client ordered from the store to their delivery destination.

2. A delivery employee with a delivery vehicle.

They would be tasked with collecting the deliveries from the store that sold us the shoe, and safely transporting the deliveries to the clients.

3. Online advertisement to attract our target market to our store.

We would need an advertisement employee to help advertise the business and make it known that there is an easier way to shop for branded shoes that they like even though their shoe size is scarce.

4. Easy to use and accessible app.

A well functioning app that is available on playstore would be needed for clients to be able to purchase shoes online and therefore I would need to look at user reports and run maintenance and upgrades on the app.

Maintainance of my app

- I would have a contact us page on the app allowing clients to write reports on recommendations that they would want to see incorporated into the app. These recommendations would be reviewed at the end of the month and applied if necessary to ensure that the application only requires minimum downtime which would affect the profit of the business.

- I would also need to ensure that the app sends emails to stores on a monthly basis confirming if they still have old stock available, and checking if there are new designs that have been added to their stock so that I am able to add it to my apps stock list.

- I would need to ensure that the delivery vehicles are road worthy every 4 months by taking them in for servicing should they need to be serviced.

Cost benefit analysis per unit sold

My cost benefit analysis would be based on the price of each shoe sold on my app, pricing the delivery fee of each shoe sold at 18% of the actual shoe size, therefore allowing the

price to continuously increase with the number of shoes that they order leading to a greater profit margin.

Total Income	118%
Income from unit purchase purchase	100%
Cost on deliver fees	20%
Total expense	113%
Unit purchased from external stores	100%
Delivery fuel cost	2%
Delivery man salary	3%
Advertisement fees	3%
Owner salary	5%
Total profit	7%

Scalability of the store:

The business would be easily expandable as it would require only two main procedures to expand to other provinces.

- The business would first need to get delivery employees that are based in those provinces to decrease the delivery expenses of the business from Gauteng to another province.

- I would then be required to speak to the different retailing branches in those provinces of the stores that I would be partying with, to work out an agreement that would allow my business to contact them through our website on the availability of stock. To ensure that we are able to purchase stock from their business when a client orders on our website.

Target market

- Men with shoe sizes from 8-12
- Females with shoe sizes from 6-9

SOLUTION 2:

Online store that sells the address to location of the shoe store that has the shoe that a client would want to purchase.

To combat the scarcity of oversized shoes in stores and the time wasted trying to find the shoe that the client would want by going from store to store. I want to propose the solution of an online store which would display oversized shoes that are available on the market and require a certain fee for the client to access the location of the store that has their shoe size therefore spending less time in malls trying to find their preferred shoe size in different stores.

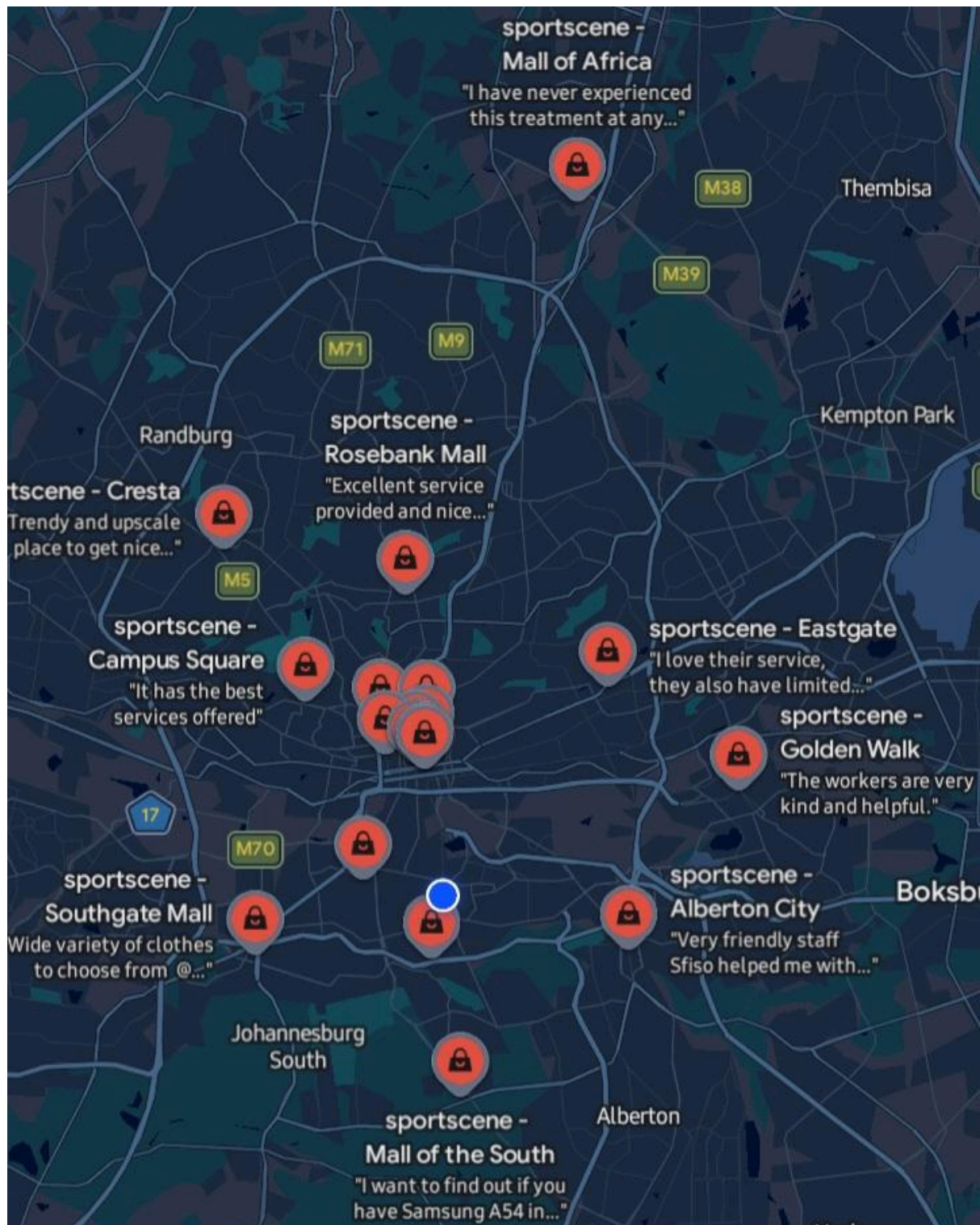
This would allow people with big feet to get the exact shoe that they want by going onto my app to select the shoe that they want. They would pay a certain fee in order to access the location and name of the store that has the shoe in their size, therefore I would be monetizing shoe stores locations.

I would need to get partnering stores and branches that would allow my app to send them email requests asking if they have the shoe that was ordered on my app. After they confirm having the required shoe. My app would then send a response requesting a fee in order for the client to access the address of the store's location closest to them that has their desired shoe.

The store branches that I would want to partner with would be:

- 1.Side step
- 2.Sudio 88
- 3.Sportscene
- 4.Shoe city
- 5.Kingsmead shoes
- 6.Splitz

The main reason why I would want to partner with these three stores is because they have multiple branches across Gauteng and South Africa, making it easier for me to handle transportation fees. This would be done by always ensuring that the store location is a relevant distance from the clients house.



To run my online store I would need:

1. Cooperation of stores to give us access to their trading stock that we advertise online.
2. Good online advertisement to attract our target market.
3. Easy to use and accessible websites.

Reasons why I would need these resources:

1. The Cooperation of stores to allow us to access their trading stock that we advertise online.

• My website would allow a customer to look for the shoe that they want in a short period of time on my website. When they have confirmed their order, my website would be required to send emails to all the stores that I would be partnering with requesting for the shoe design that the customer wants. Should they have it, my app would then notify the user to pay for the exact store locations which have their shoe sizes available therefore letting them choose which shoe store they would like to purchase their shoes from.

2. Good online advertisement to attract our target market.

We would need an advertisement employee to help advertise the business and make it known that there is an easier way to shop for branded shoes even though their shoe size is scarce.

3. Easy to use and accessible websites.

A well functioning and easily accessible app on playstore would be needed for clients to be able to purchase shoes online and therefore I would need to look at user reports and run maintenance and upgrades on the website.

Maintainance of my app:

I would have a contact us page on the app allowing clients to write reports on recommendations that they would want to see incorporated into the app. These recommendations would be reviewed at the end of the month and applied if necessary to ensure that the application only requires minimum downtime which would affect the profit of the business.

I would also need to ensure that the app sends emails to stores on a monthly basis confirming if they still have old stock available, and checking if there are new designs that have been added to their stock so that I am able to add it to my apps stock list.

Cost benefit analysis per unit sold:

My cost benefit analysis would be based on the price of each shoe sold on my app, pricing the sale of the store's address at 14% of the shoe price that the client wants to purchase, therefore allowing the price to continuously increase with the number of shoes they want access to.

Total income	14%
Sale of store address	14%
Total expense	8%
Owner salary	5%
Advertisement fees	3%
Fee paid to stores to monetize their locations	3%
Total Profit	3%

Scalability of the store

To expand my business idea to other provinces in South Africa, I would need to get into contact with the different store branches and discuss what the fee would be in order for me to be able to monetize their locations.

From there I would apply them to the same procedure that I use with the Gauteng stores.

Target market

- Men with shoe sizes 8-12
- Women with shoe sizes 6-9

Reviewing both possible solutions



SOLUTION 1:

Online shoe store with medium to oversized shoe sizes available for purchase and delivery.

SOLUTION 2:

Online store that sells the address to

location of the shoe store that has the shoe a client would want to purchase.

•Comparison of each possible solution

Solution 1	Solution 2
Would have delivery expenses	Would not have delivery expenses
Greater profit margin for the business	Lesser profit margin for the business

Requires more staff members	Requires less staff members and more cooperation from stores.
Ensures customer always receives their purchase by delivering the products ourselves.	Does not ensure that customers would receive their purchase when they arrive at the store, as it could be sold prior to their arrival.

Benefit of each possible solution

<u>Solution 1</u>	<u>Solution 2</u>
It would provide my business with a greater profit margin.	The business would not have any delivery fees.
It would ensure that the customer always gets their order delivered to them	The business would need less staff members to operate

•Negative outcomes of each solution

Solution 1	Solution 2
-Transportation of goods to other provinces besides Gauteng would require external transportation therefore decreasing business profit.	-Clients could potentially complain about having to pay for a location and finding the stock sold out; therefore giving the business bad reviews.
-More staff members are needed to operate the business.	-Our app would have to get permission from stores to monetize their location.
-The business is dependent on stores that might sell the stock to other clients.	-Our website would need to pay certain stores a higher fee to monetize their locations.
	-Selling store locations would result in smaller profit margins.
	-Clients might complain about locations that

	have their requested sizes being too far from their houses.
	People might not be keen on paying for a location instead of the actual product.

Conclusion

I have selected solution 1: Online shoe store with medium to oversized shoe sizes available for purchase and delivery.

My reasons for selecting this solution are:

- it would provide me with a greater profit margin.
- It would allow me to ensure that the product is always received by the customer through transportation.
- It will spare me from having to pay a fee to the stores in order to monetize their store locations
- I have more control over the customer-client experience by enabling continuous contact with the client should they want to be contacted during delivery when the package is on its way to its destination.

Comparison of my solution 1 to other similar businesses out there.

<u>My business</u>	<u>Other similar businesses</u>
I would source my products from stores and not factories ensuring that products can be collected from the store branch closest to the customer decreasing transportation fees.	Sourcing products from factories may require high transportation fees due to the location of the factory being far from clients.
I am catering for a target market that is ignored and the popular target market by selling from sizes 8-12, allowing me to have a greater availability of customers.	Their target market is only profit based therefore leading to a limited product availability for customers.
By contacting different store branches instead of factories; I am ensuring that I have access to different shoe designs while being close to residential areas.	By contacting manufacturing factories they are limited to what the factory is currently producing unless they venture to further factories for different designs.

The downside of selecting solution 1 are:

- The business is based in Gauteng therefore purchases outside Gauteng would result in extra transportation expenses without increasing the transportation fees too much. Gauteng.
- More staff members are going to be needed to transport goods out of the province.
- The business is dependent on stores that might sell the stock to other clients before we get a buyer for the stock.

The business scalability:

The business would be easily expandable as it would require only two main procedures to expand to other provinces.

- The business would first need to get delivery employees that are based in those provinces to decrease the delivery expenses of the business.
- I would then be required to speak to the different retailing branches of the store Side Step in the different provinces, to work out an agreement that would allow my business to contact them through our website on the availability of stock. To ensure that we are able to purchase stock from their business when a client orders on our website.

INPUT, FUNCTIONS AND OUTPUTS OF MY E-COMMERCE STORE.

INPUTS

•Availability of a domain name

Description:

The store should be easily accessible on web browsers using the right, easy to remember domain name that is not similar to other stores.

•Creating an account

Description:

The client should be able to create an account using their email address and would be required to fill in a form with their personal details such as their name and gender to enhance their user experience.

•Buying a shoe

Description:

The customer is able to buy a shoe by tapping on the image of the shoes that they want to purchase from my e-commerce store.

•Availability of online shopping cart

Description:

All the shoes they want to purchase from my store would be added to their personal online shopping cart which should be displayed on the screen.

•Payment methods of purchases

Description:

The client would have to pay for the goods which they have purchased electronically by filling in a form that will ask for their banking details and a phone number that we can contact them with and address that the shoes would be delivered to.

•Updating available stock on my e-commerce store

Description:

A weekly email would be sent on a Monday from my e-commerce store's email address to each store that we buy shoes from. This email would ask these stores if they have run out of the stock that we have displayed on my e-commerce store. The email would also ask if there is any new shoe design that they have in store for us to display on my e-commerce site.

Thirdly the email would ask if there is any decrease in the shoe prices due to specials of the shoes that we already have displayed on our e-commerce store.

•Shoe ordering process

Description:

When a customer has finished paying for their online shopping cart, the shoe they bought needs to be ordered for them automatically.

•Delivery of purchased items

Description:

An email will be sent to our client from our website letting them know that their order would be delivered to them within four business days.

- Shoe display on website

Description:

The shopper would be able to filter out what shoes they are able to see by selecting “all”, “men” or “women” on the navigation bar of the app.

- Customer review and opinions and recommendations

Description:

The customer is able to provide the business with a review of their customer service experience on the app. By clicking the contact us option on the navigation bar.

- The about us section of my e-commerce store

Description:

On the navigation bar of my e-commerce store there should be an about us link taking users to the about us page of my e-commerce store.

FUNCTIONS

- Availability of a domain name

Description:

I would have to set up my e-commerce store on Google Chrome and other web browsers and give it an easy to remember domain name that is descriptive, therefore giving clients an idea of what type of e-commerce store I would be running. The domain name would be “Kicks motion”, therefore making it short and easy to remember.

- Creating an account

Description:

By creating an account on our e-commerce store our client's email address along with the rest of the form that they fill in would be stored on our database allowing the website to keep track of which client purchased what item from our e-commerce store and to keep track of how many online clients that we have. It would also allow us to keep track of what shoe is popular to the specific genders.

- Buying a shoe

Description:

All the shoes that they want to buy from my store would have an email address attached to them in the backend, which allows a message to be sent to all the partnering stores requesting for the shoe that has been bought on my e-commerce store as soon as the client buys and pays for their shopping cart.

- Availability of online shopping cart

Description:

All the shoes that a client selects to purchase from my e-commerce store should be displayed in their online shopping cart allowing the client to deselect any shoe that they do not want to buy anymore. It should also give the client the ability to see how much their total of all the shoes that they want to buy would be.

- Payment methods of purchase and ordering from suppliers

Description:

By paying for stock via EFT my store receives immediate payments from the bank for the shoes that the customers have ordered. This allows my business to pay the store branch that has the shoe we want to purchase for the customer immediately. Ensuring that the shoe would not be sold to walk in customers.

- Updating available stock on my e-commerce store

Description:

Upon receiving a reply from the stores we purchase shoes from about a stock update, I would be tasked with editing all the stock on my e-commerce store by removing any shoes that have been sold out from the stores shopping list. I would also add all the new shoe designs that are now available in the stores we buy our shoes from and fill in the necessary shoe details such as the price of the shoe, and image of the shoe and the shoe sizes that are available. The email addresses of the stores that have those shoe designs would be attached to those shoes in the backend.

- Shoe ordering process

Description:

Each shoe displayed on our website would have multiple email addresses of the stores we buy our shoes from attached to them in the backend. The moment an online shopping cart has been paid for, an image of the shoes in those carts would be sent to the respective stores, requesting to know if they still have the designs in store. The first store to reply is the store from which the shoe will be purchased from via EFT.

- Delivery of purchased items

Description:

Every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, the drivers working for my e-commerce store would receive a message from my e-commerce store letting them know the details of which store they should go to collect the shoes which my business has purchased from the store branches which we are partnering with and what address to deliver the shoe to along with the phone number that would be used to contact the clients. Upon collection of the shoe from the store; an SMS would be sent to the phone number the client has provided the e-commerce store with, letting the client know that their shoe would be delivered to them on that day. Only making deliveries every two days ensures that the trips a driver would make to collect purchased stock is minimized therefore saving on fuel expenses.

- Shoe display on website

Description:

The shoes being sold would be separated into three different categories on the website being “all”, “men” and “women”. This will be a filtering process ensuring that the customer has the display of shoes that they are interested in and would like to buy.

- Customer review and opinions and recommendations

Description:

The customer would rate the business customer service out of five stars and provide an opinion about the customer service that they received in the text area space provided for them. This would allow customers to voice their opinions. Their responses should be recorded by the e-commerce store and sent to the Human Resources email to be reviewed.

- The about us section of my e-commerce store

Description:

The about us page should display information of what inspired the development of the app and how the app should function along with our trading license of my e-commerce store. It should be a clear description that is able to answer any questions a client has about my business module.

OUTPUTS

•Availability of a domain name

Description:

This would allow any new client that wants to shop for shoes on my e-commerce store to find and access my e-commerce store easily when they search for it using the domain name "Kicks motion".

•Creating an account

Description:

The client would be registered as a customer on our e-commerce store by creating a shopping account with their email. It would allow the client to view their previous purchases by logging in with their email. The client would also be able to receive an online receipt of their purchase which is sent to their email address that they have created their account with.

•Buying a shoe

Description:

By tapping on the shoe that they want to purchase, the item should be added to their shopping cart which would be displayed on the screen with the total amount they accumulated through their purchases. This should allow them to review all their purchases before paying to make sure that they have bought designs that they like.

•Availability of online shopping carts.

Description:

The customer can review their online shopping cart which should contain all the shoes that they selected to buy, therefore allowing them to remove previously selected items if they feel like they do not like the design anymore or to cater for their spending budget.

•Payment methods of purchases

Description:

By paying via EFT, the customer is able to receive an online receipt which will be sent to their emails almost instantly therefore keeping proof of the transaction made with my e-commerce store.

•Updating available stock on my e-commerce store

Description:

The online shoppers would be able to see all the available stock on our website with clear details about each item being sold in my store. They would also not have to end up purchasing a shoe that has been sold out due to the system's stock being updated weekly.

•Shoe ordering process

Description:

By paying the stores that we are ordering the shoes from immediately via EFT, my website ensures that the shoe is kept stored away until it is picked up for delivery.

•Delivery of purchased items

Description:

Our clients would receive a phone call from the driver as soon as the driver has arrived at their drop off location I, so that they may collect their packages and sign off on it. This ensures that the package has not been sent to the wrong address and that the shoe is not collected by unauthorized personnel.

•Shoe display on website

Description:

By filtering the shoes into gender categories the e-commerce store ensures that customers would not have to struggle trying to find their preferred taste in shoes.

•Customer review and opinions and recommendations

Description:

By reading the customer review forms, the business is able to make adjustments to the customer service that is offered to the clients and the display and functionality of the e-commerce store.

•The about us section of my e-commerce store

Description:

By viewing the about us page of my e-commerce store, clients should have an understanding of which gap in the industry my e-commerce store is trying to cater for. They should also be well informed about my business based on what description is given on my "about us" page.

Example of how the app would work.

-If a customer wanted to shop on my e-commerce store they would look for my store on chrome or other web browsers using the domain name "Kicks motion".

-My e-commerce store should pop up as one of the possible store suggestions.

-When they click my website to enter my website; they should be met with the logging in option as the first page. This allows them to be registered as a customer on my e-commerce store therefore keeping track of their purchases which they would be able to review whenever they come back to the app.

-After filling the required details the rest of the app would be displayed on the user's screen allowing them to start on the home page which displays all the shoes that they are able to buy.

-There would also be a navigation bar at the top of the page which allows her to navigate her way around the app. The navigation bar would display the following:

- Shop (which would include a drop down option)
- About us
- Contact us

-If the customer is a female and she wants to only see the shoes designed for women, there would be a drop down option on the home link of the navigation bar allowing her to filter the shoe designs displayed for her.

-The shoes would be displayed as an image which have the shoe sizes and prices displayed right underneath each shoe.

-By clicking on the shoe , the shoes would be automatically added to her online shopping cart.

-When she is done selecting all the shoes she wants to buy she would click on the shopping cart displayed on the right hand side of her screen allowing her to review all her purchases and remove items if she feels like the total items added to her cart is too expensive.

-When she clicks on the buy, she will be given a form to fill in. By filling in that form she would provide us her number which we can contact her with, and her banking details to make the payment to my e-commerce account.

-As soon as she is done making her purchase, an e-receipt of her purchase would be sent to her with an attachment that notifies her that her purchase would be delivered within business days.

-On the day of her delivery as soon as the delivery man has collected her order from the store which will provide us with what she has ordered, she would receive an SMS from our e-commerce store in the morning between nine and ten o'clock to let her know that her delivery would be made to her on that day.

-When the delivery man arrives at the drop off address which she has specified he would call her to notify her to come and collect her delivery. She would then be required to sign with her signature confirming that her purchase has been delivered to her.

-By phone calling her our business is ensuring that the customer does receive their package and that the drop off address is not wrong due to errors made by Google maps.

Summary of my business model.

My business model would be an online e-commerce store that allows people to purchase goods online by just being on their phones instead of spending an hour to two hours in the mall going from store to store trying to find their shoe size.

My app would be easily accessible on web browsers using the domain name Kicks motion. This would allow any customer to find my e-commerce store on the device that they are using to search for my store.

My app would have a login detail allowing customers to be registered clients on my e-commerce store. By being a registered customer they would be able to have their purchase history available to them when they come online.

There would be a navigation bar with the following:

- Shop (with a drop down allowing them to filter the shoes that they are able to see)
- About us
- Contact us

The navigation bar would be used by the shopper to help them easily navigate their way around my e-commerce store.

The “shop” page would have images of the shoes sold on my e-commerce store displayed with the shoe name, shoe sizes and the price of the shoe right underneath the shoes image.

The “about us” page would have a description of my e-commerce store allowing customers to read a medium length description of the store and why it was started.

The “contact us” page would allow customers to fill in a form detailing any recommendations or problems with the customer service that they received from my business.

When they select the shoes that they would like to purchase from my e-commerce store, they would be provided with an online shopping cart that keeps record of all the shoes they want to purchase

The shopping cart can be reviewed before they pay for what they want in case they want to remove any shoe from the items that they want to purchase.

They would be required to fill in their banking details along with their phone number that is used to contact them when their purchased items are delivered to them.

The shoes that a customer orders would be purchased from branches that we partner with in the following way.

Each shoe has an email of the store that confirmed having that shoe. When a cart is paid for, the email is sent to the stores that said they have the shoe to request if they still have the shoe in stock. When a store replies confirming that they have the shoe, the shoe would be bought from that store and delivered by our personal delivery drivers to the customers drop off locations that they have provided us with.

The business would update the shoes displayed on our website weekly by requesting for a stock update via email. These emails are sent to the store branches that we buy the customer's shoes from. Upon receiving a reply the website would add any new shoe designs that the stores have provided us with and remove any shoe design that has been sold out in all the store branches.

The business would mainly make a profit by charging the customers with a delivery fee for the shoes that are ordered in my store.

RESEARCH PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS USING SURVEYS

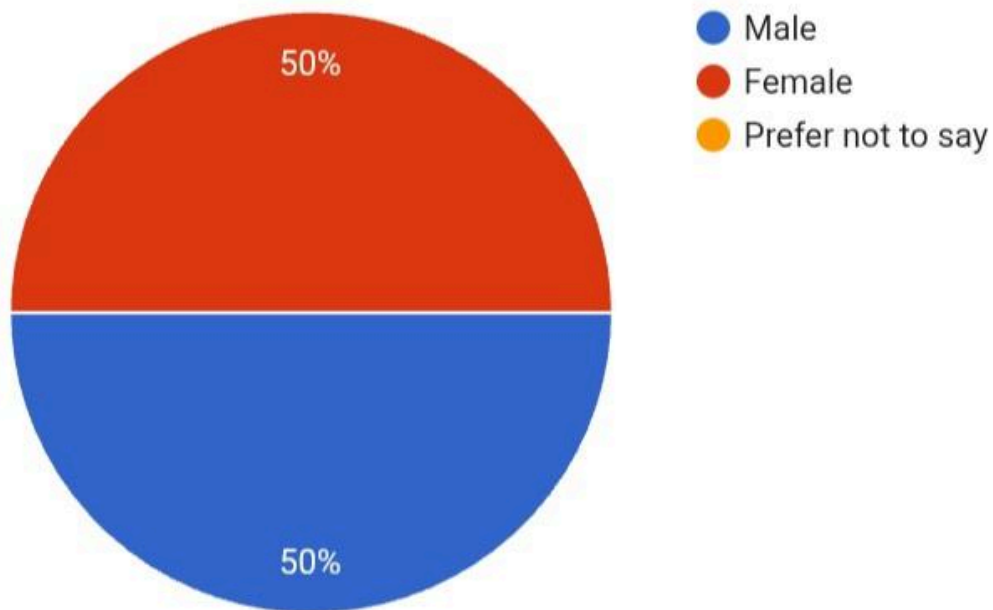
This survey was created with the sole purpose of understanding the type of experience clients have when they partake in online shopping. It was also done to understand what application features they wanted to see when using online shopping apps. By conducting this research we are able to know what are the necessary key components that need to be included in our application to stand out from the rest of the online shoe stores that already exist out there.

The participants of this survey consisted of 50% males and 50% females to ensure that the results weren't gender biased and covered the preferences and experience of both genders when they partake in online shopping.

What is your gender?

20 responses

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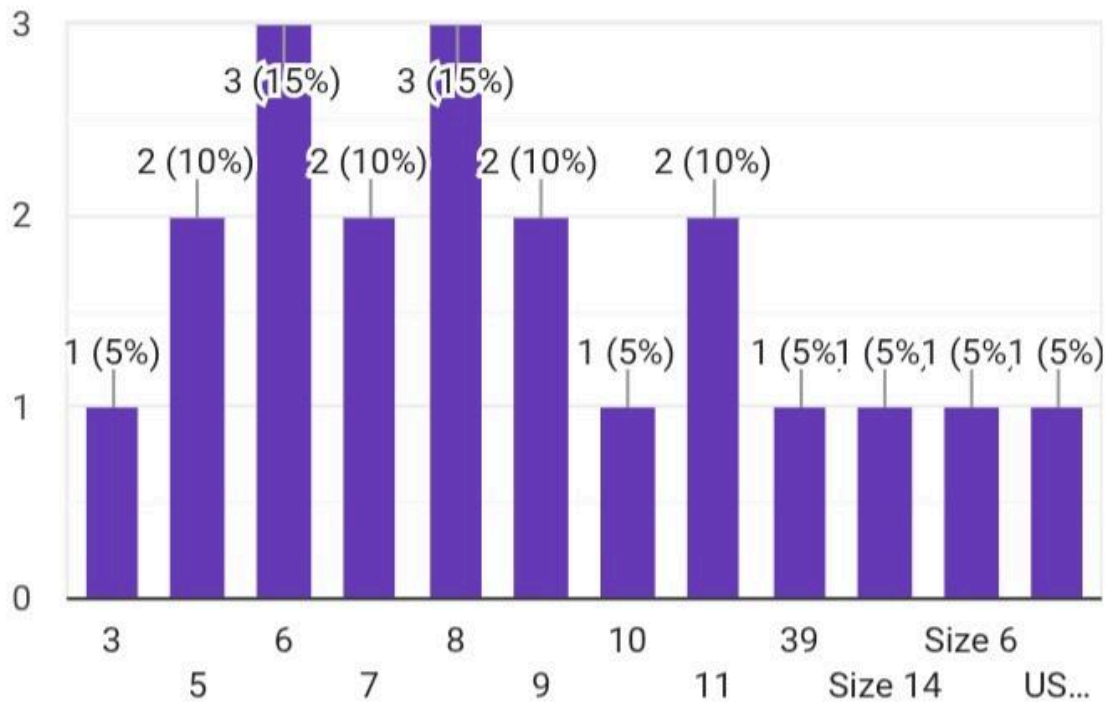


The survey randomly selected candidates between the ages of 18 to 40 years of age. The process of randomly selecting candidates was also done to project the experiences of people with different shoe sizes and shoe preferences in the survey. By randomly selecting candidates it also shows how the average shoe sizes of males and females range between size six and size eight.

What is your usual shoe size.



20 responses



User needs analysis

When we asked online shoppers what challenges they have experienced when buying shoes online they gave us the following responses.

- Females with big feet often have to buy male designed shoes because they are not catered for.
- The shoe quality of the shoes they purchased was not the best.

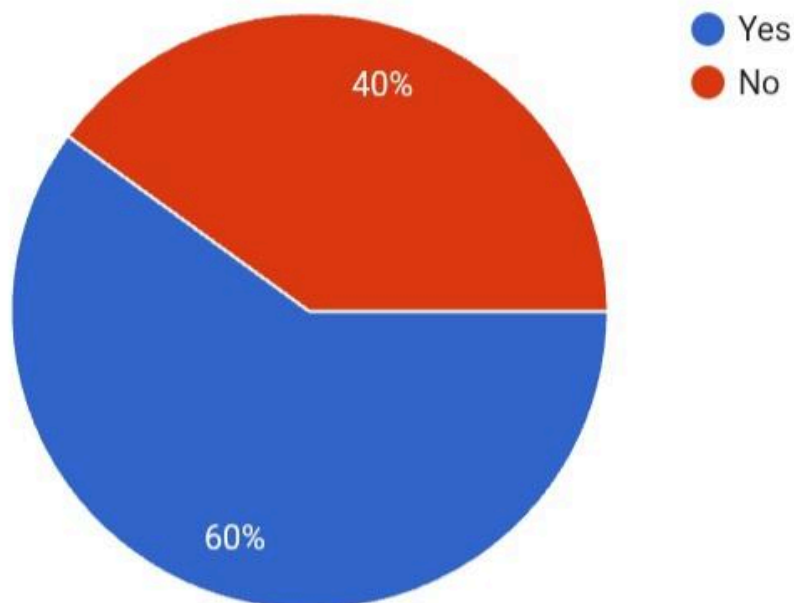
- They struggled to find the right shoe size as there were no shoe size guides.

We asked shoppers if they have ever struggled to find their shoe sizes online

Have you ever struggled to find your shoe size online?

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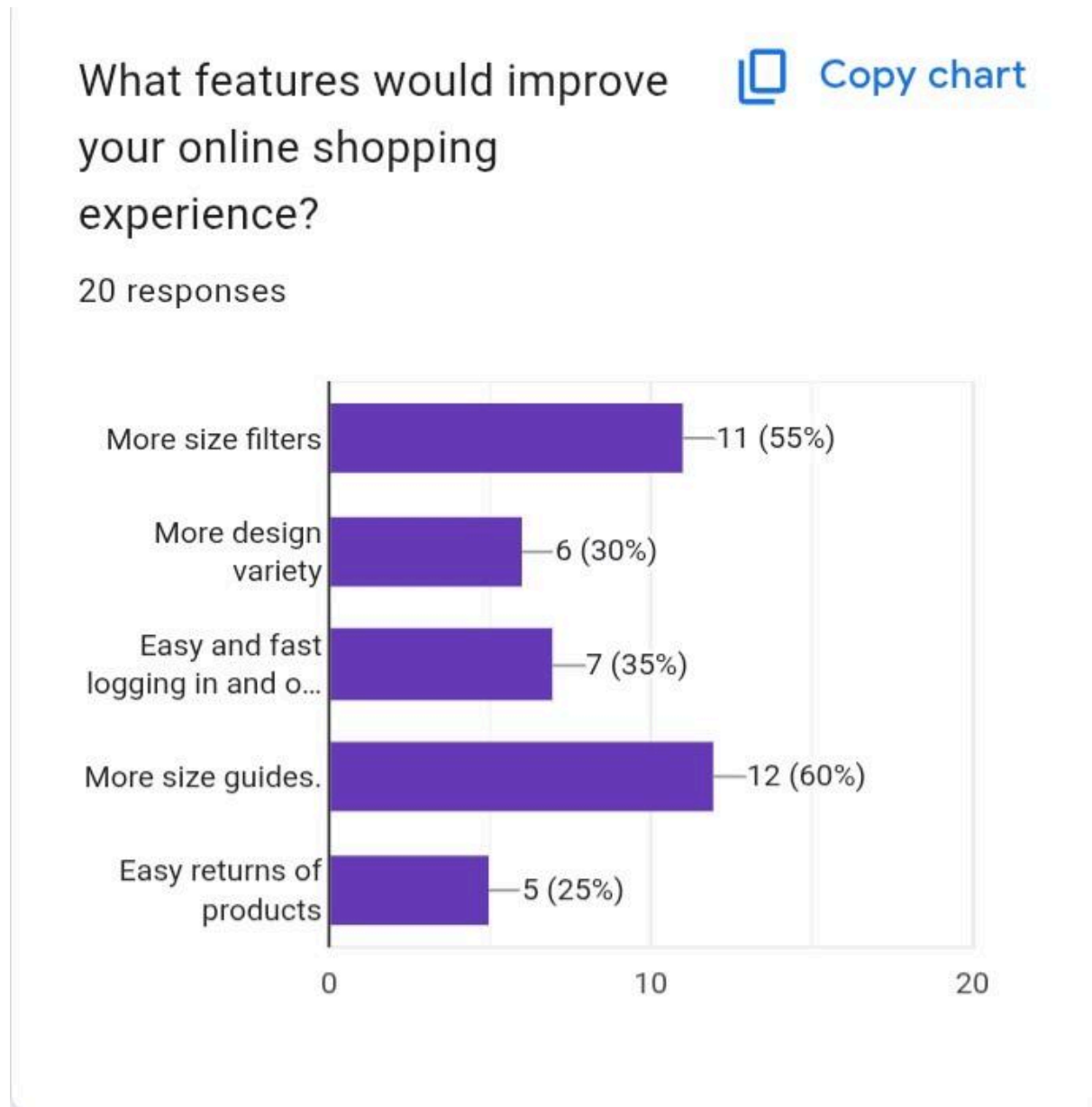
20 responses



60% of users said the struggle find their shoe sizes online and the main reasons were:

- Their shoe sizes were out of stock.
- They did not have the designs that the client wanted in their shoe size.
- The online shoe store displayed the shoe sizes in a different standard of shoe measurement which made it hard to figure out what shoe size to pick.

When we asked users what features they would like to see on online shopping stores they provided us with the following.



The main points online shoppers highlighted are the following:

- Users would prefer having more size guides to navigate their way around online shoe stores.
- Users would also want the process of logging in and out of their shopping accounts to become easier.

Market analysis

Benefits offered by the leading online shoe stores out there:

Nike

- They provide quality shoes and are trusted as a brand by being well known.
- They offer a variety of shoes ensuring that they have different shoe categories available to the customers

Zappos

- They offer customers an extended warranty allowing customers to return goods if they are not satisfied with the quality of the goods.
- They provide fast delivery times when they have to deliver their customers orders.

Disadvantages of the leading online shoe stores out there:

Nike

- They only offer Nike designed shoes to customers limiting their brand range.
- They sell their shoes at very expensive prices that a lot of customers are not able to afford.

Zappos

- They are only based in certain locations therefore have the inability to deliver to customers who are not in the desired locations.
- They offer little discounts on goods and services and tend to be more expensive with the pricing of goods.

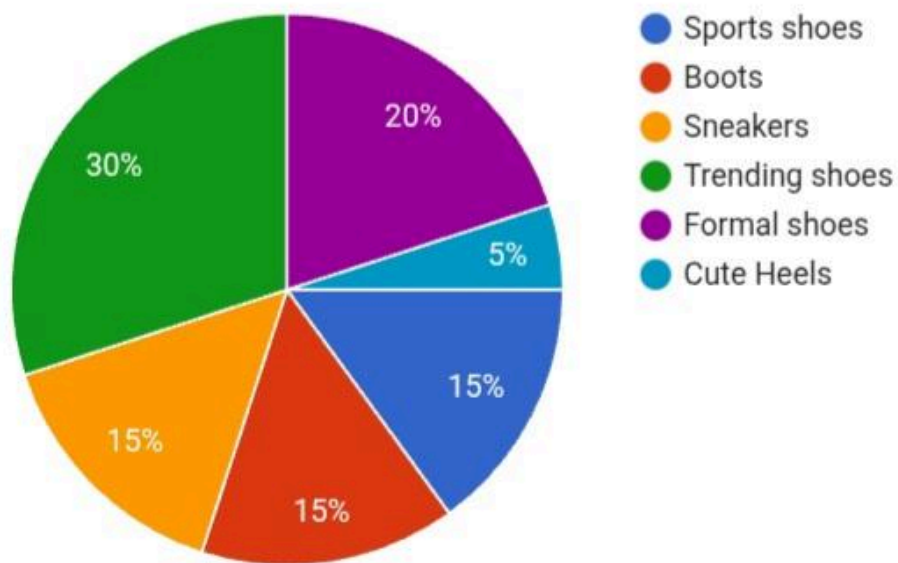
Market trends

- The online shoe stores are mainly accessed through mobile phones and are preferred to ensure that less time is spent in shopping malls.
- Customers also prefer to purchase trending shoes from online shoe stores which become sold out easily.

What type of shoes do you struggle to find when you shop for shoes online?

20 responses

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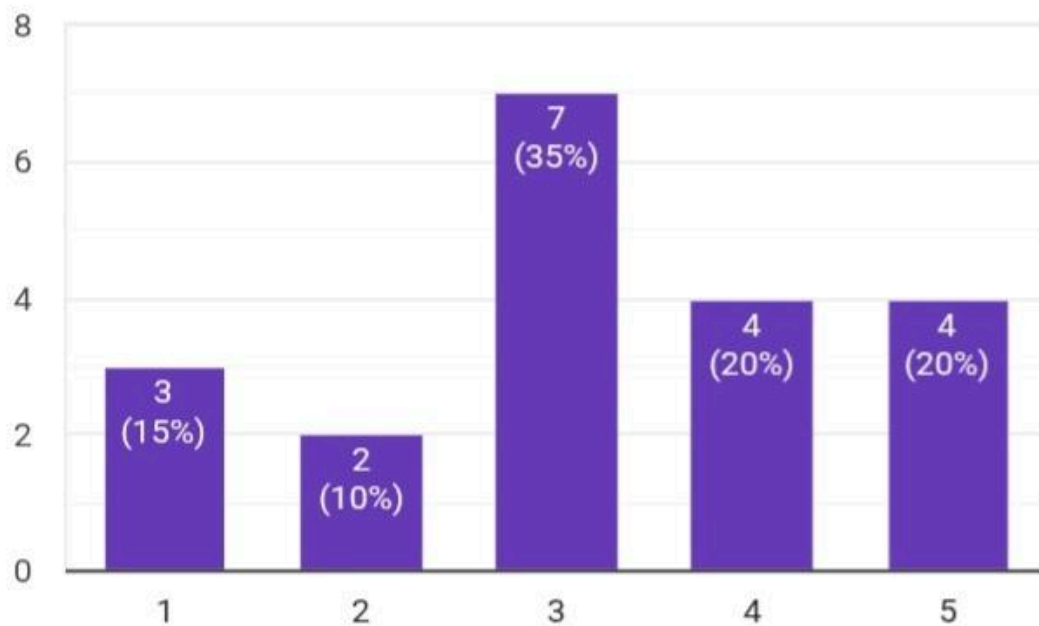


•Customers prefer shopping on online shoe stores that are not limited in terms of the shoe designs available on their website.

How satisfied are you with the variety of shoe designs available in your shoe size?



20 responses



Gaps and opportunities

- To ensure that my online store stands out, I would have to make sure that I provide customers with a greater variety of shoe designs and make sure that they are not limited to one size.
- I must ensure that my store provides fast deliveries to the customers.
- The prices of my shoes in the store should not be too expensive, therefore offering seasonal specials to ensure that customers use my online store more.

- I must make sure that the store application is responsive on mobile devices to cater for the large market of online shoppers who shop using their phones.
- Our online store should offer a 15 day return policy allowing our customers to return any goods they are not satisfied with.

Technological assessment

Devices used

- The online shoe stores are mainly accessed through mobile phones and are preferred to ensure that less time is spent in shopping malls.
Therefore we should ensure that our mobile store is responsive on mobile devices to ensure that our user experience is the same for all the users.

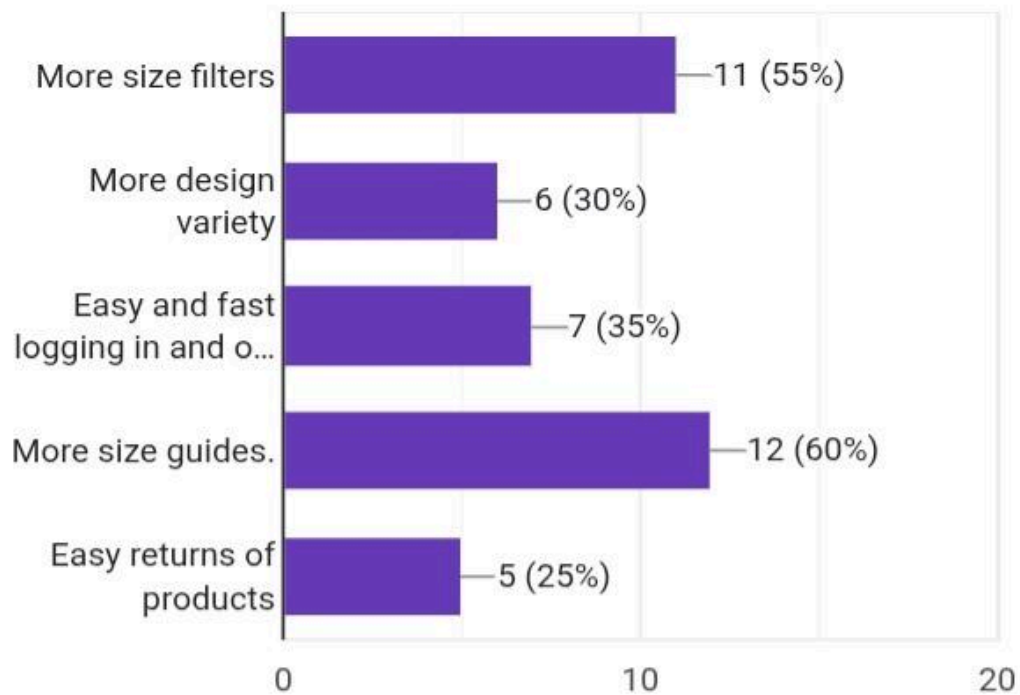
Features needed

- Online shoppers found it hard to navigate their way around different shopping apps and therefore due to a lack of filtering systems the features they mainly want to see implemented are shoe guides and easy logging in and out to ensure that the shoe store is easy to use.

What features would improve your online shopping experience?

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20 responses



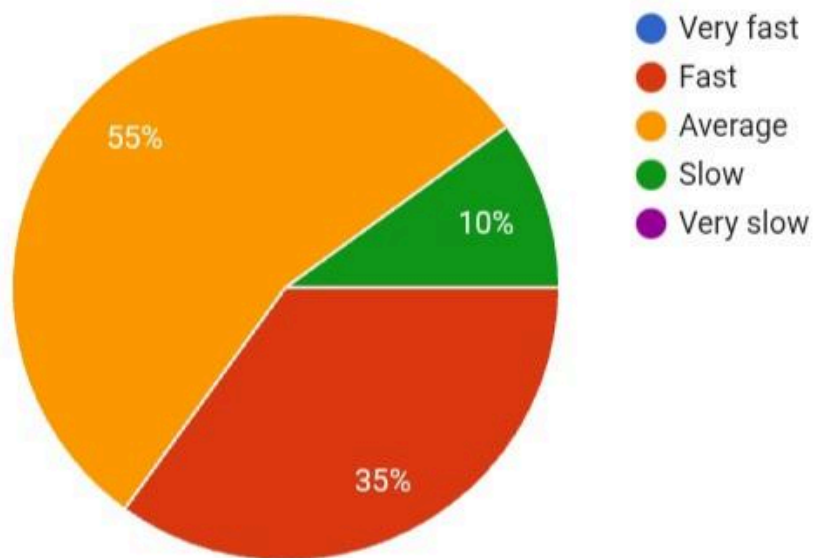
Delivery time of shoes purchased

•Customers prefer to shop on online shoe stores that provide fast deliveries because they might need to get the shoe in a short period of time for their own personal reasons such as a birthday gift or for an outdoor event. We therefore have to ensure that our online store provides fast deliveries so that our clientele is able to increase.

How well would you say the delivery times of online stores are when you order shoes?

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20 responses



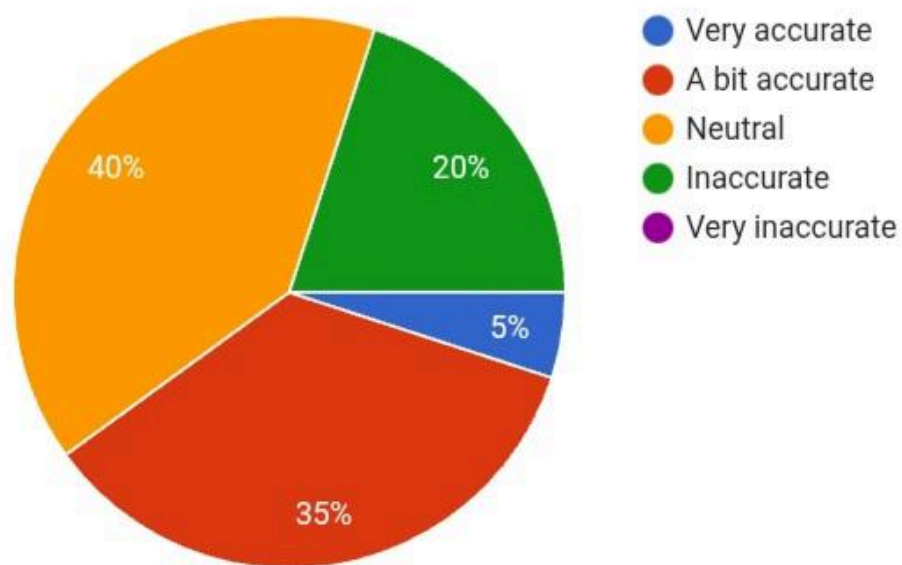
Risk assessment

Shoe sizing

How accurate is shoe sizing when you buy your shoes online?

20 responses

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•My online store should make sure that it provides the UK standard of shoe sizing to ensure that the shoe sizes are not confusing to our online customers. This would also ensure that they do not get a small cut for the shoes that they ordered leading to bad client reviews.

Return of shoes policy

•Clients usually return shoes because the quality of the shoes they purchased does not align with what they had in mind so my business needs to make sure that we outsource the shoes from trusted suppliers.

Security and authentication

- Our website should provide a two step verification process that clients are allowed to select to ensure that our clients are able to secure their accounts; this should be done to ensure that the clients accounts are not hacked.

Obtaining customers

- To ensure that customers trust our newly developed application when we launch it we would need to ensure that we collaborate with big brands so that customers are able to trust our store.

- We would need to ensure that our store gets a lot of good online reviews to let customers know that our business is legitimate.

- We would also need to provide our customers with quality shoes that are original so that our customers do not complain and offer the business bad reviews.